KANVACOL

Business Rules & Workflow

Draft v1 · Requirements discovery

Product vision
A collaborative digital paper where people can sketch rough ideas, use AI to make them more legible, and invite the world to improve them—while preserving each contributor's work and credit.

Purpose of this document

Capture the business behavior discussed so far before moving into database design or implementation. These are draft requirements: agreed concepts are documented, while unresolved decisions are explicitly called out.

Guiding principles

Collaboration first	The product is about ideas evolving through many contributors, not just publishing finished images.
Consent to publish	Saving privately and publishing publicly are separate actions.
Independent contributions	Proposals never overwrite the original or another contributor's work.
Quality through discovery	The feed should surface compelling ideas, with community support helping determine the featured version.
Preserve attribution	Version history remains available and every contribution stays credited.

Status: Draft for discussion — not yet a final technical specification.

1. Business Rules

Canvas creation and publishing

1. Users can create a new canvas and draw ideas freely.
2. Users can optionally use AI to refine drawings and make ideas more legible.
3. Users can save a canvas privately without publishing it.
4. **Saving and publishing are separate actions.** A canvas becomes publicly visible only when its owner explicitly chooses to publish it.
5. Published canvases become available for discovery through the public feed.
6. Users can continue developing an idea before deciding to publish it.

Public feed and discovery

7. The home page features a vertically scrollable feed of published ideas, similar to familiar social-media browsing patterns.
8. Users can discover ideas across backgrounds, disciplines, and areas of interest.
9. Users can upvote, downvote, comment on, and explore published ideas.
10. A clearly visible pen/create action lets users start a new canvas at any time.
11. The platform may later feature unfinished ideas or AI-generated starting points that users can develop.
12. The feed should prioritize compelling, high-quality ideas and encourage participation.
13. The interface should minimize clutter and work intuitively, especially on phones and tablets.

Ownership and attribution

14. Every canvas has an identifiable original creator who owns the original contribution.
15. Other users can contribute improvements without directly overwriting the original work.
16. The original contribution remains accessible even if another version becomes more popular.
17. Every contribution retains attribution to its creator.
18. The original contribution and subsequent versions must be distinguishable.

Alternative versions and pull requests

19. Users can select a published idea and create an independent copy.
20. Users can edit their copy without changing the original canvas or other users' contributions.
21. When ready, a user can submit the version as a pull request (PR) asking the original owner to review it.
22. Each PR is associated with the original idea and its contributor.
23. Multiple users can submit alternative versions of the same idea simultaneously.
24. One user's submission does not prevent another user from creating or submitting a different version.
25. Submitted versions can coexist even when the owner has not reviewed or approved them.

Exploring versions

26. Each published idea has a clearly visible **“See Other Versions”** action.
27. Selecting it opens a dedicated page displaying the original idea and its alternatives.
28. Users can explore and rate the different versions on that page.
29. Versions are presented in a ranked order based on community voting.
30. The interface makes contributions discoverable without overwhelming users.
31. The original creator’s version remains accessible in version history even if it is no longer first.

Voting and featured versions

32. Users can upvote or downvote versions to express their preferences.
33. Community voting helps determine which version receives priority in the public feed.
34. **Initial ranking rule:** if Bob’s version receives more upvotes than Alice’s currently featured version, Bob’s version takes priority.
35. When an alternative takes priority, it becomes the featured version for that idea.
36. The previously featured version remains accessible under “See Other Versions.”
37. All versions remain attributed to their creators, regardless of ranking.
38. The featured version can change as community support changes.

Owner accountability

39. Owners should be encouraged to review submitted PRs and respond to proposed improvements.
40. Owners should not be able to permanently suppress alternative ideas simply by ignoring them.
41. A well-supported alternative may become featured even if the original owner has not responded.
42. Losing featured status does not delete the original contribution or remove its attribution.

Drawing history and process transparency

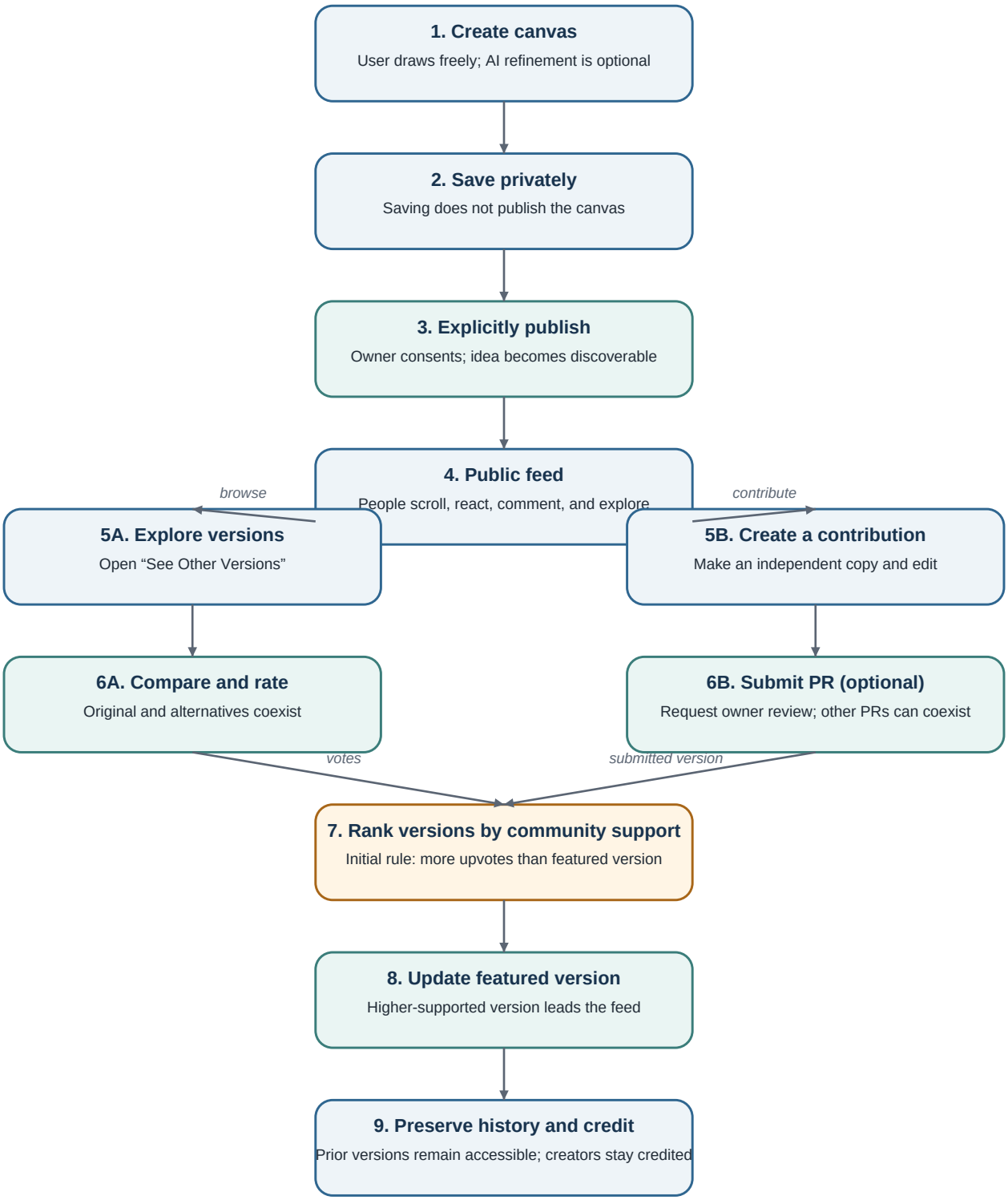
43. A published canvas presents its finished result.
44. Users should have the option to explore the steps used to create the drawing.
45. The drawing process should use numerical markings or step-by-step ordering so viewers can follow how the idea developed.
46. The goal is to help viewers understand the creator’s thought process and identify gaps or opportunities for improvement.

Engagement and incentives

47. The platform encourages people from different backgrounds to participate in solving problems and developing ideas.
48. Users may receive points or recognition for contributions and published work.
49. User profiles should reflect contributions and activity.
50. Points and participation may influence user visibility and incentives.

2. End-to-End Workflow

The diagram below captures the agreed high-level path from creation to discovery, contribution, voting, and featured-version changes. It intentionally leaves unresolved PR merge details open.



Draft workflow. PR acceptance/merge behavior and exact voting mechanics remain open decisions.

3. Decisions Still Open

These questions should be resolved before treating the requirements as implementation-ready or designing the database schema.

Topic	Question to resolve
PR acceptance and merging	When an owner accepts a PR, does the submitted version become the new editable canvas, or can the owner merge selected parts into the current version?
Voting mechanics	Do downvotes reduce a version's score, or are they displayed separately? What happens when versions tie?
Vote integrity	Can a user change their vote? Can they vote more than once on a version? What safeguards are needed against coordinated or fake voting?
Ranking changes	Does featured status update immediately when upvotes change, or only after a threshold or review?
Owner response expectations	Is there a response deadline for PRs? What happens if an owner is inactive for a long time?
Version visibility	Should all PRs be public immediately, or should some remain private until the contributor submits them?
Drawing history	Is step-by-step drawing history required or optional? How should AI refinements appear in the history?
Points and incentives	Which actions earn points, and how exactly do points affect profile status or visibility?
Feed quality	Besides votes, should the feed consider topic, recency, diversity, or quality signals to help new but promising ideas get seen?
Content safety and moderation	How should spam, abusive content, plagiarism claims, and inappropriate submissions be handled?

4. Suggested Next Step

Walk through one scenario end to end: Alice creates and publishes an idea; Bob submits a PR; the community rates both versions; Bob's version receives more upvotes; and Bob's version becomes featured while Alice's remains accessible and credited. For each step, specify the actor, trigger, expected result, and any exceptions. Once these behaviors are precise, translate them into data entities, relationships, and constraints.